

1996



Dolly the sheep, the first mammal to be cloned from an adult animal's DNA, in her pen at the Roslin Institute in Edinburgh, Scotland.

CHECHNYAN REBEL LEADER

Salman Raduyev was shot on March 6 and reported dead (he had in fact disappeared abroad for medical treatment). A

ceasefire was signed between Russia and Chechnya (see 1994) on August 31.

Romanian elections were won by the Romanian Democratic Convention, bringing 48 years of communist rule to an end.

Civil war began in **Afghanistan**, when Taliban rebels seized Kabul on September 27, forcing hundreds to flee the war-torn city.

The Kurdish civil war continued, and Iraq seized a city inside the Kurdish "safe haven" protected by



BSE cases

Bovine spongiform encephalopathy, or "mad-cow disease", caused a major health scare in Europe. Most cases of BSE occurred in the UK.

sides to find a solution to Northern Ireland's political problems.

US president **Bill Clinton** won another term in office on November 6. When Clinton reshuffled his cabinet on December 12, **Madeleine Albright** became the first female American Secretary of State.

Science fact met science fiction when **Dolly**, a sheep, was born on July 5 in Edinburgh, Scotland. Dolly was the first mammal to be **cloned** from an adult cell.



Online shopping

The online auction site eBay boomed in 1996 with clever technology and a forum for rating buyers and sellers. It is now a global phenomenon.

17 THE NUMBER OF MONTHS THE IRA CEASEFIRE LASTED

US-led troops on August 31. In response, America launched **Operation Desert Strike**, firing missiles at Iraqi military targets.

The **IRA** (Irish Republican Army) exploded a bomb in the Docklands area of East London on February 10, ending a 17-month ceasefire (see 1994), which had tried to enable both

1997

\$1,835,300,000

THE GROSS REVENUE EARNED AT THE BOX OFFICE BY THE FILM TITANIC

VIOLENCE IN ZAIRE ESCALATED in February, intensifying the misery of Rwandan-Hutu refugees who had fled there to escape the civil war in Rwanda. In April, rebel soldiers, mainly Tutsis, sealed off camps in eastern Zaire, where refugees were trapped in appalling conditions. Thousands were massacred. The government of Zaire collapsed on April 3, and **Etienne Tshisekedi** (b. 1932) became prime minister of the new government. As the violence escalated 56,000 Zaireans fled into Tanzania.

Albania was consumed by anarchy during March and April, as law and order collapsed. When

Guggenheim museum

This museum in Bilbao, Spain, designed by US architect Frank Gehry, was opened on October 18.

government insurgents began nearing the capital Tirana, those loyal to President Sali Berisha armed civilians in Tirana, opening up stores of guns and ammunition. The result was chaos, and foreign nationals were urged to leave.

Hong Kong was handed back to the Chinese authorities on July 1 after 150 years of British rule. The new chief executive, **Tung Chee Hwa**, formulated a policy based on "one country, two systems," to preserve Hong Kong's role as a capitalist center in Asia.

Diana, Princess of Wales, died in a car crash on August 31 in a Paris underpass. The news of her death was greeted with unprecedented scenes of mourning around the world.

Iraq refused to allow UN **weapons inspectors** entry in

October. The inspectors had been sent in the aftermath of the 1991 Gulf War with a remit to destroy Iraq's nuclear, biological, and chemical weapons arsenal. This action provoked a **diplomatic crisis** which was defused by a Russian-brokered compromise.

In Japan, the **Kyoto Protocol** was signed on December 11. It committed industrialized nations to reducing emissions of greenhouse gases, principally carbon dioxide, in an attempt to combat **global warming**.

The film *Titanic*, about the ill-fated voyage of the famous passenger liner that sank in 1912, was premiered in December. At the time, it was the most expensive film ever made, but also the most successful, grossing over \$1.8 billion. It also won 11 Academy Awards (Oscars).



January 2 US troops enter Bosnia as part of UN peacekeeping mission

June 23 Death of Greek statesman **Andreas Papandreu** (b. 1919)

February 10 Docklands bomb blast in London by IRA shatters ceasefire

July 5 Scientific breakthrough made with birth of **Dolly**, a sheep cloned from adult DNA

July 19-August 4 Atlanta, Georgia: US hosts Summer Olympics

September 27 Taliban capture Afghan capital of Kabul

November 3 Communist rule ends in Romania

February 19 Death of **Deng Xiaoping**, leader of China (b. 1904)

March 13 Turmoil on streets of Albanian capital Tirana

April 3 Government in Zaire (now Congo) collapses

June 20 *Harry Potter and the Sorcerer's Stone* by J.K. Rowling published

July 1 Hong Kong formally handed back to China after 150 years of British rule

June 25 Death of Jacques Cousteau, underwater explorer (b. 1910)

October 29 Iraq bars UN weapons inspectors; tension in Gulf increases

August 31 **Diana, Princess of Wales** (b. 1961) dies in a car crash

November 17 Tourists gunned down by Islamic extremists at **Hatchepsut's tomb** in Luxor's Valley of the Kings

December 4 Over a hundred countries ban use of landmines

December 11 **Kyoto Protocol** drawn up in Kyoto, Japan, to combat global warming